

Steppe — Conflict of Interest Register

Document: Conflict of Interest Register **Version:** v2 **Status:** Active **Maintained by:** Founding Executive Director; reviewed by the Board **Last updated:** 2026-07-08

Purpose and scope

This register is the canonical record of disclosed conflicts and related-party relationships affecting Steppe’s directors, officers, and staff. It operationalizes Steppe’s Conflict of Interest Policy [policy reference — TBD; the policy itself is not yet in the counsel packet] and sits alongside the recusal provisions in the governing documents. A relationship is recorded here whether or not Steppe is a party to it: a private commercial relationship between two directors, or a family relationship between a director and a Steppe counterparty, is disclosable on its own terms because it can bear on board independence.

Standing recusals

- **Cobb — Redmond Compass.** Director Holli Cobb (owner, Redmond Compass) recuses from any Steppe-Redmond Compass organizational matter, **and from any matter in which Mr. Chism or his entities have a financial interest** (see Entry 001).
- **Weimer — Herringbone Books.** Should Steppe and Herringbone Books ever enter a paid arrangement, Director Brandon Weimer recuses from any board matter touching it. Ordinary platform membership is not a conflict.
- **Weimer — Ignite Empowerment Foundation (fiscal sponsor).** Director Weimer is the spouse of IEF’s founder; he recuses from every Steppe-IEF matter (see Entry 002).
- **Chism — own compensation & entities.** Director/ED Gregory Chism recuses from setting his own compensation and from any matter in which Sunbreak LLC or Three Canyon Consulting LLC has a financial interest, **including matters involving Redmond Compass or Ms. Cobb** (see Entry 001).

[COUNSEL] Confirm which recusals (if any) belong in the Articles of Incorporation versus the Conflict of Interest Policy / bylaws. Entrenching individual, person-specific recusals in the Articles is rigid (directors change; Articles amendment is heavy); the policy/register layer is usually the better home.

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#	Party	Relationship	Steppe a party?	Disclosed	Status
001	Greg Chism / Three Canyon Consulting LLC ↔ Redmond Compass (Director Cobb)	Paid commercial engagement between the ED’s LLC and a fellow director’s company	No	2026-06-26 (confirmed 2026-07-08)	Active; board review pending

#	Party	Relationship	Steppe a party?	Disclosed	Status
002	Director Brandon Weimer ↔ Ignite Em- powerment Foundation (Steppe's fiscal sponsor)	Director is the spouse of the fiscal sponsor's founder	Yes (Steppe-IEF sponsorship)	2026-07-08	Active; board review pending

Entries

001 — Three Canyon Consulting Redmond Compass

- **Disclosing person:** Greg Chism, Founding Executive Director and director.
- **Nature:** Mr. Chism, through **Three Canyon Consulting LLC** (confirmed 2026-07-08 as the holding entity), holds a commercial engagement providing application-development services to **Redmond Compass**, whose founder, Holli Cobb, is a Steppe director. The engagement is at market rate under written contract.
- **Steppe involvement:** None. Steppe is not a party and contributes no funds, assets, or staff time.
- **Why recorded:** Two Steppe directors hold a private commercial relationship in which funds flow from a director's company (Redmond Compass) to the ED's LLC (Three Canyon). This creates an **indirect financial relationship** between Mr. Chism and Ms. Cobb: **neither is disinterested as to the other**, and neither may approve the other's interested-person transactions or the other's matters (including ED compensation, for Ms. Cobb).
- **Interaction with the no-Steppe-client rule:** The engagement is the one existing exception to Three Canyon's commitment to take no Steppe-related clients; going forward Three Canyon takes no **new** such clients, and Mr. Chism has committed to wind this engagement down (COI Disclosure Packet, Part 3, item 7).
- **Recusal terms (board-adopted):**
 - Director Chism recuses from any Steppe decision involving Redmond Compass or Ms. Cobb's businesses, and from setting his own compensation.
 - Director Cobb recuses from any Steppe decision involving Mr. Chism or his entities, including ED compensation, and from Redmond Compass matters.
 - The engagement is a private commercial matter conducted at arm's length, creating no Steppe obligation.
- **Engagement start date:** *[TBD — supply for the record]*
- **Disclosed:** 2026-06-26 · **Facts confirmed by ED:** 2026-07-08 · **Board reviewed:** *[pending]*

002 — Director Weimer Ignite Empowerment Foundation (fiscal sponsor)

- **Disclosing person:** Brandon Weimer, director (and, as needed, the ED on the organization's behalf).
- **Nature:** Director Weimer is the **spouse of the founder of Ignite Empowerment Foundation (IEF)**, which is **Steppe's confirmed fiscal sponsor** (sponsorship agreement pending signature). Under the arrangement, IEF holds and re-grants Steppe-directed funds and charges an administrative fee.
- **Steppe involvement:** Yes — Steppe is a party to the fiscal-sponsorship relationship with IEF.

- **Why recorded:** A family relationship between a Steppe director and the fiscal sponsor's founder bears directly on board independence and makes the Steppe-IEF relationship (agreement, admin fee, fund flows, transition off sponsorship) an **interested-person / related-party matter**. It also means Director Weimer — otherwise the board's most independent member relative to the Chism-Cobb conflict — is **not** a clean, universally disinterested director.
- **Recusal terms (board-adopted):**
 - Director Weimer recuses from any board deliberation or vote on the fiscal-sponsorship agreement, the sponsor administrative fee, fund transfers to or from IEF, or the transition off sponsorship, and is not counted toward the quorum approving them.
 - The Steppe-IEF terms are approved by the disinterested directors on arm's-length terms and documented contemporaneously.
 - Director Weimer remains available to serve as a disinterested approver of matters unrelated to IEF (e.g., ED compensation, Redmond Compass matters), subject to the board-composition note below.
- **Board-composition note:** With Chism, Cobb, and Weimer each carrying a disclosed relationship, **no current director is free of every conflict**. Steppe plans to **seat a fourth, fully independent director** to provide a clean, plural disinterested body for the most sensitive approvals.
- **Disclosed:** 2026-07-08 · **Board reviewed:** *[pending]*

Board actions log

Date	Action	Reference
2026-06-26	ED disclosed the Three Canyon-Redmond Compass engagement; entered as #001.	Entry 001
2026-07-08	ED confirmed #001 is held by Three Canyon Consulting LLC and is a current, arm's-length engagement to be wound down; COI Disclosure Packet updated to v1.4.	Entry 001
2026-07-08	Weimer-IEF spousal relationship disclosed; IEF confirmed as fiscal sponsor; entered as #002.	Entry 002
<i>[pending]</i>	Board received disclosures 001 and 002, confirmed recusal terms, and (re)confirmed the composition of the disinterested approving body; noted the plan to seat a fourth independent director.	Minute <i>[ref]</i>

Board minute (ready to enter)

The board received the ED's confirmation that the disclosed Three Canyon Consulting engagement with Redmond Compass (founder, Director Cobb) is held by Three Canyon and is a current arm's-length engagement to be wound down (Entry 001), and the disclosure that Director Weimer is the spouse of the founder of Ignite Empowerment Foundation, Steppe's fiscal sponsor (Entry 002). The board confirmed the recusal terms recorded in the register, noted that no current director is free of every conflict, and recorded the plan to seat a fourth, fully independent director to constitute

a disinterested approving body for compensation and interested-person transactions. No Steppe resources are involved in the Three Canyon engagement.

Changelog

- **v2 (2026-07-08):** Entry 001 updated (Three Canyon confirmed as the holding entity; indirect Chism-Cobb financial relationship and mutual recusal recorded). Entry 002 added (Weimer ↔ IEF fiscal-sponsor spousal relationship). Standing recusals expanded (Weimer-IEF; Chism-own entities/comp; Cobb-Chism matters). Counsel flag added on Articles-vs-policy entrenchment.
- **v1 (2026-06-26):** Register created. Standing recusals referenced from the Articles. Entry 001 (Three Canyon ↔ Redmond Compass) added; board review pending.